

## **Initiative Video Reflection**

**Reflect on your own experiences in school or at an internship or workplace. In one-two paragraphs state how you can take the initiative to help further your career.**

Throughout school and work, I have learned that taking initiative means doing more than just completing assigned tasks. It involves asking questions, volunteering for new responsibilities, and looking for ways to improve my skills without being told. As I continue working toward my career goals, I can take the initiative by participating more in class discussions, seeking feedback from instructors and supervisors, and taking advantage of internships and networking opportunities. These actions will help me gain valuable experience and build professional relationships that can benefit my future career. **(Word Count: 77)**

I also plan to continue developing my technical and communication skills by completing certifications, attending workshops, and staying informed about changes in my field. Taking initiative means being proactive instead of waiting for opportunities to come to me. By showing reliability, maintaining a positive attitude, and consistently looking for ways to improve, I can demonstrate leadership qualities that employers value. These habits will help me grow professionally and increase my chances of long-term career success. **(Word Count: 76)**

## **Growth Mindset vs. Fixed Mindset**

**1. Think about a recent challenge you have faced, whether it is educational, professional, or personal. Reflect on how you handled the challenge, your thought process through it, and the outcome.**

A recent challenge I faced was balancing multiple class assignments while also managing personal responsibilities. At first, I felt overwhelmed because several deadlines were approaching at the same time. Instead of giving up, I created a schedule, prioritized my assignments, and completed each task one step at a time. Although it required extra effort and better time management, I successfully finished my work on time and learned that staying organized reduces stress and improves my overall performance. **(Word Count: 80)**

**2. Which mindset do you think you used while navigating the challenge? Provide examples.**

I believe I used a growth mindset while working through this challenge. Instead of thinking I was incapable of handling everything, I reminded myself that I could improve with better planning and effort. I accepted that I would make mistakes along the way and used them as opportunities to adjust my schedule and study habits. This mindset helped me stay motivated and focused on finding solutions rather than becoming discouraged by temporary setbacks. **(Word Count: 76)**

**3. If it was not a growth mindset, what are some changes you would make?**

Although I mostly demonstrated a growth mindset, there were moments when I doubted myself. If I had relied on a fixed mindset, I would have believed that I simply was not good at managing my workload. To improve, I would focus more on asking for help when needed, viewing challenges as opportunities to learn, and reminding myself that skills develop through consistent practice. These changes would help me become more confident and resilient in future situations. **(Word Count: 77)**

**4. What are some steps you can take toward developing or continuing a growth mindset?**

To continue developing a growth mindset, I plan to set realistic goals and celebrate small improvements instead of expecting perfection. I will continue seeking feedback from instructors and supervisors because constructive criticism helps me grow. I also want to reflect on challenges after they happen so I can identify what worked well and what I can improve. By staying curious, practicing persistence, and learning from mistakes, I can continue building confidence and resilience. **(Word Count: 75)**

**TED Talk: *What I Learned from 100 Days of Rejection* by Jia Jiang**

**1. What are the 2-3 most important lessons from Jiang's talk?**

One of the biggest lessons from Jia Jiang's talk is that rejection is a normal part of life and should not stop us from pursuing our goals. Another important lesson is that many people are willing to say yes if we simply ask respectfully and explain our request. Finally, Jiang demonstrates that rejection can become a valuable learning experience instead of something to fear. By changing how we respond to rejection, we can become more confident and open to new opportunities. **(Word Count: 82)**

**2. What is your attitude about rejection? Do you fear it enough to avoid taking initiative?**

I do not enjoy rejection because it can be disappointing and make me question my abilities. However, I realize that avoiding opportunities because of fear only limits my personal and professional growth. Watching Jiang's presentation reminded me that rejection is often temporary and does not define my potential. I want to become more comfortable taking reasonable risks because each experience can teach me something valuable, even if the answer is no. **(Word Count: 75)**

**3. Describe a specific instance where fear of rejection prevented you from trying something or taking initiative.**

One time I hesitated to volunteer for a leadership role during a group project because I was worried that my classmates would not support my ideas. Instead, I stayed quiet and allowed someone else to lead the project. Looking back, I realize I missed an opportunity to strengthen my leadership and communication skills. If I faced the same situation today, I would volunteer despite my fears because even an unsuccessful attempt would provide valuable experience. **(Word Count: 80)**

**4. What is the worst rejection you've experienced? With the lessons of Jiang's talk in mind, is there anything to learn from that experience?**

One of the most difficult rejections I experienced was not being selected for a position I had hoped to receive. At the time, I felt discouraged and questioned whether I was qualified. After reflecting on the experience, I realized I needed to strengthen certain skills and gain more experience before applying again. Jiang's message reminds me that rejection is not the end of the journey but an opportunity to improve, grow, and prepare for future success. **(Word Count: 81)**

**TED-Ed: *Boosting Confidence***

**1. How does confidence relate to taking initiative?**

Confidence plays an important role in taking initiative because it gives people the courage to act even when they are uncertain about the outcome. When individuals believe in their abilities, they are more likely to volunteer for new responsibilities, share ideas, and solve problems without

waiting for instructions. Confidence also helps people recover from setbacks because they trust they can continue improving. Developing confidence encourages greater participation and stronger leadership in school and the workplace. **(Word Count: 77)**

## **2. What can you do to develop your confidence?**

I can develop my confidence by preparing thoroughly, practicing my skills regularly, and setting realistic goals that allow me to see steady improvement. I also benefit from accepting constructive feedback because it helps me identify areas for growth instead of focusing only on mistakes. Celebrating small accomplishments reminds me that progress happens gradually. The more experience I gain through practice and persistence, the more confident I become in handling future challenges. **(Word Count: 75)**

## **3. What are some quick fixes that have made you feel a sense of confidence in the past?**

Some quick strategies that have helped me feel more confident include preparing ahead of time, reviewing my notes before presentations, and maintaining positive self-talk. Taking a few deep breaths and focusing on previous successes also helps reduce nervousness. Dressing professionally and maintaining good posture make me feel more prepared and capable. These simple habits allow me to approach challenging situations with a more positive and confident mindset. **(Word Count: 75)**

## **4. How could you practice overcoming challenges in your workplace?**

I can practice overcoming workplace challenges by volunteering for new projects, asking thoughtful questions, and accepting responsibilities that push me outside my comfort zone. When

problems arise, I will focus on finding practical solutions instead of becoming discouraged. I also plan to learn from experienced coworkers by asking for feedback and observing effective communication skills. Over time, consistently facing challenges will strengthen my confidence, improve my abilities, and prepare me for greater responsibilities. **(Word Count: 77)**